Kerala, naming officers of the IB and Kerala Police who fabricated the case, and seeking appropriate action against them.

Twenty-three years after I was implicated in the case, my family has been able to regain much of our pride; my son and daughter no longer have to live as a traitor's children; the media considers me a phoenix. But some of the damages the conspirators and their foot soldiers inflicted are irreparable. Like my career and my wife's mental peace.

A nation rebounds faster than a family. India's PSLV is today one of the most reliable and sought after rockets for satellite launches. India has developed its own cryogenic rocket engine to take heavier satellites to the geosynchronous orbit and send probes to the unexplored corners of the solar system.

But the ISRO spy case was able to delay India's cryogenic engine by at least 15 years. What does one gain from that? For one, a lot of money. India today offers to launch a satellite at a fraction of the price that NASA charges. A 2015 report of the Colorado-based Space Foundation pegged the global space economy of 2014 at $330 billion, with a 9% growth over the previous year. Satellite launches and related commercial activities constitute 75% of it.

It is in public domain how the US applied sanctions on India and Russia in 1992, a year after the two countries signed a contract for transfer of cryogenic technology. Piece together the timing of the ISRO spy case and a few later incidents, including a top IB man being given marching orders for supping with the CIA, and you see the plot.

There was a time when I wanted to end it all, but I had to live to tell the tale. And see my tormentors get their comeuppance. This book is not an effort in revenge. This is an experiment in something more powerful: truth.

— S Nambi Narayanan